

Rohtas' Wajidpur gains a bridge over the Kaw River—cutting its distance to the sub-divisional HQ by 71 km, a boon for farmers. Kaimur's Mohania, Bhagalpur's array of paths, and Buxar's Dhansei Bazaar will sport new bypasses. Samastipur and half a dozen other districts join the list. Ring roads will encircle key towns like Muzaffarpur, while bridges and ROBs promise seamless travel—over 300 bridges were built b etween 2005 and 2020, and the Yatra envisages to add dozens more. Bihar's jam-packed days are numbered—soon, a trip to Patna from anywhere in the state will take just three to four hours, down from eight or more a decade ago.

A HOLISTIC OVERHAUL

Infrastructure isn't just concrete. Agriculture and irrigation, long neglected, have got a big boost. Patna's embankment from Didarganj to Punpun will widen, with a plea to the central government for ₹525 crore in support. Nalanda's Sarmera block sees Zamindari dams refurbished, while Noor Sarai and Harnaut get eight anti-flood sluice gates—a response to 2023 floods that displaced two lakh people. The Panchane irrigation scheme will be revived, irrigating 50,000 hectares. Across districts, canals will be fortified, and river interlinking—linking the Sone to the Falgu—will combat drought and floods, a lifeline for farmers who produce 8 million tonnes of rice annually.

Healthcare leaps forward with seven medical colleges adding 700 MBBS seats annually. Education expands with nine degree colleges, like in Begusarai, tapping a literacy rate that's climbed from 47% in 2001 to 70% in 2021. Industry grows with eight new zones—Bhojpur's agro-processing hub among them—while tourism flourishes with revamped sites like Bodh Gaya's Mahabodhi precinct. Power grids and interstate bus terminals round out the vision in a tapestry of progress, weaving together every sector.

After these schemes take root, Bihar will match pace with frontrunner states in a year or two. The state government's road-building spree since 2005 has laid the groundwork—road density hit 225 km per 100 sq km by 2020, rivalling Punjab's 220. Now, high-speed corridors will turbocharge connectivity. Traffic jams will fade, and economic activity will surge. The Pragati Yatra's big-billion infusion promises lakhs of jobs, fuelling a continuing cycle of growth.

The government schools in the state now have 2.5 lakh new teachers since 2023, hospitals boast doctors and free drugs (80% coverage), and jobs draw talent to Bihar ranging from Uttar Pradesh to Tamil Nadu. Patna's flyovers and upcoming metro reinforce a modern, vibrant capital. Even local brand Sudha, a dairy cooperative under COMPFED, is going global—its sweets now reach the US and Canada, exporting ₹21 crore worth in 2024, hinting at Bihar's untapped potential.

THRIVING ON THE YOUTH

The state's ace is its youth—60% of its 12-crore people are under 25, a demographic dividend waiting to be harnessed. With smart human resource use—IT hubs in Patna or skilling via the Kushal Yuva programme, training 5 lakh youth since 2016—Bihar could join India's elite states in near future. Nitish Kumar's Pragati Yatra has lit a new spark, turning hope into momentum. As the edifying vision of Viksit Bharat by 2047 beckons, Bihar is all geared up to contribute to its realisation as a prominent player in India's development story.

Shedding its backward label way behind, Bihar's achievements span all sectors. The landscape is changing, and the state is ready to shape a new, aspirational journey.

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